

Quote Notes

Ethan Kennedy

Evans

English 10

2/13/23

Dark Matter

After he woke up in the lab his life would change. In the novel *Dark Matter*, Blake Crouch explores the themes of reality and identity. Jason, the main character, loses touch with his original reality when he's kidnapped and wakes up completely different. The author shows reality and identity throughout the book throughout the story, like finding who you really are by putting the things that feel different and using them to find who you truly are or where you belong. The thought of reality is really important in this book and how the author portrays it, but in the author's perspective on Jason is how Jason is trying to find himself while hopeful but the reality of what confusing it is something you need to find, your reality has to make sense to you and if not find it as how Jason finds his old life with knew bits and pieces added on.

In this novel, the theme of reality is shown through Jason and his trying to recollect himself and find what's real after his kidnapping. On page 72 a quote states "At this point, I'm not even sure what to be afraid of - this reality that might actually be true or the possibility that everything is going to pieces inside my head" this explains Jason's pov of trying to put together what has changed after he escaped from the lab and he's trying to find who he is even doubting himself or having a blurred vision about who he is or where he belongs. Another way that the author shows reality while connecting it to identity is "I guess minutes aren't transferable across the multiverse", this quote shows the author's message of reality by showing how versions of his

timeline are not clear and how things are different no matter where he goes. It shows the theme by saying how scattered different things that make sense are what you make of them.

The way that the author shows identity in the novel is by showing how Jason is lost in different versions of himself. The quote "Makes me wonder, who is the ideal Jason? Does he even exist?" shows how Jason is trying to find what is the right thing or who. This also connects to the theme because he is not sure if the right one even exists or the ideal one and the theme talks about how you need to find yourself and who you are by putting the pieces together even if things are really scattered. This other quote relating to identity is "They're the original." "None of us are." "No. We're pieces of a composite" how it shows the theme is by showing how he and all other versions of himself are pieces of one main character and how they are all scattered. This also shows how they matter if they find out how to put themselves together after trying to recall piece after piece throughout the whole book.

In conclusion, the themes of identity and reality are significant in the book and oneself in the real world as well. The author may have meant these two themes to be significant to the reader since these are things one can feel or go through and the author may want you to understand or feel a connection to Jason through identity and what happens or has happened to you after something. In today's world struggle with identity and reality is real in a lot of people through experiences and mental conditions along with feeling. The way it's powerful is because so many people can relate to having reality and identity issues. In real life, identity can be seen through LGBTQ+ people and others who feel as though they aren't who they really think and

believe there's something missing. Reality is in the real world to like what's really happening like war or living with something that you just have to accept or find.

The key here is to begin writing assignments as early as possible. You are capable of interesting ideas, and while you built to some good ones here and while you and I had some good conversations, the final product is just too confusing and poorly edited in places. You need to leave yourself time to edit and revise your writing to convey your best ideas more specifically. Let's meet about how to properly set up quotations, how to eliminate "fluff," and how to break up confusing ideas into smaller, clearer sentences.

SPEECH:

Have you ever had to rebuild your life from the ground up well In the book dark matter Identity and reality is a struggle for Jason the main character after that one faithful night he was kidnapped and drugged and woke up a different person with all his life changed like it never existed. He wondered why this had happened to him and where all the normal aspects of his life had gone. Further more trying to find his wife Daniela and his son charlie again. Some of you may be thinking what does it feel like to lose everything or to discover everything unrecognizable, these are feelings i had while i read the book and I put myself in his shoes to get a further understanding of all the great aspects of this book. You'll feel the deep connection between jason and his family especially his wife who was everything to him gone in a heartbeat and i guarantee youll gain that bond along with jason because of the way the author made the writing interesting.

some of you have issues understanding who you are or parts of yourself and are trying or have found yourself. While you read this book you might have a few observations of why its so great but when it comes to the themes reality and identity, youll see these a lot especially later in the book when jason finds out what the invention he made had done, the box it was called allowed him to travel to different realities and has different versions of himself throughout those realities. I think the plot is great because its unguessable and keeps you interested no matter what happens to him that you dislike.

The entertainment aspect of this book is great because of the situations or the exhilarating feeling that you get seeing what happens in each reality and which jason matters and want to desperately know what happens next. Its also interesting with the sci-fi mystery aspect of it wondering what happens next in jasons life is great for anyone who wants a thriller. The point im trying to make about why is this book is great and should be read is its entertaining

and relatable with people our age in some aspects like finding who you really are and its important because alot of people aren't able to read a story about finding identity through a cool mystery book and thats why i think the tenth grade should study it.